

DRAMA IN THE DELUGE

Max Verstappen prevailed at the Canadian Grand Prix and Ferrari emerged victorious at Le Mans during **two rain-soaked weekends** in motorsport.



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In sports, unpredictability is often the key to coming up with an exciting show for the fans. The ever-changing variables keep everyone involved on their toes, and even the best of the lot can get tripped up by things outside their control.

This maxim is especially true in Formula One, where races in mixed weather conditions often spice up the competition. Some classic races have featured changing conditions, from dry to wet or vice versa, bringing the drivers' skills to the forefront.

Back in 2011 in Canada, McLaren's Jenson Button scored one of his most famous wins in what is widely regarded as one of the best races in recent memory. It lasted four hours and was punctuated by heavy rains, including a red flag. Button, who was at one point last in the race, won on the final lap when leader Sebastian Vettel (Red Bull Racing) ran wide on a damp part of the track.

This year's Canadian Grand Prix was eerily similar. It was another rain-affected race, with Red Bull's Max Verstappen and McLaren's Lando Norris fighting for the win in what turned out to be one of the most memorable races of the year so far. This time, however, the Red Bull prevailed.

After a disappointing sixth-place finish at the Monaco Grand Prix, Verstappen bounced back with his sixth win of the season. However, post the celebrations, the team must introspect; it was not a straightforward victory. Red Bull will feel it was lucky in Canada, thanks to rivals dropping the ball and aided by some exceptional driving from Verstappen, which masked the car's weaknesses.

Red Bull's cars are not well-suited to aggressive kerb-riding, a necessity at Circuit Gilles Villeneuve to get the best lap time. The upgraded Mercedes performed well on the Montreal track, with Lewis Hamilton topping the final practice session on Saturday

Too close for comfort: Red Bull will feel it was lucky in Canada, thanks to rivals like George Russell (right) dropping the ball and aided by some exceptional driving from Max Verstappen (left), which masked the car's weaknesses. REUTERS

morning.

In qualifying, it was nip-and-tuck between Red Bull and Mercedes. George Russell and Verstappen set identical lap times of 1:12.000, but the former took pole position because he set the time first. Though Verstappen put the car on the front row, the fact that his teammate Sergio Perez was only 16th showed how tricky the Red Bull is to drive. On Sunday, despite variable conditions, Verstappen hardly put a foot wrong and performed flawlessly, making fewer mistakes and securing his 60th career victory.

The race got underway while it was still raining, with Russell leading on intermediate tyres. However, the Mercedes driver made several errors, and after the first ten laps, Verstappen and the McLaren drivers began to pressure him with increased pace.